HENRIK MARTIN SAUER

henriksauer@icloud.com | +49 151 44361981 | Mannheim, Germany | Citizenship: German | Version: 10/2026

EDUCATION

PhD Economics *2023 – Present*
University of Mannheim, Germany
Essays on Financial and Competition Economics

MRes Economics *2021 – 2023*
University of Mannheim, Germany

MSc Economics *2020 – 2021*
London School of Economics and Political Science, United Kingdom

BSc Economics *2017 – 2020*
University of Mannheim, Germany

RESEARCH

Public Markets for Litigation Finance (Job Market Paper)
We study emerging public markets for legal cases and how they affect financing decisions and settlement bargaining. We provide a theoretical model in which a risk-averse plaintiff sells a share of case proceeds to risk-averse and informed investors, and subsequently engages in bargaining with a defendant. In both public and private markets, financing induces a legal friction by reducing the plaintiff's exposure to trial risk, strengthening his bargaining position and making court trial more likely. Its strategic use induces a financial friction. The plaintiff anticipates the commitment benefit and sells more than efficient risk sharing would justify, which strengthens commitment and further enhances the legal friction. In public markets, prices add information but need not foster agreement. A sufficiently informative public price may in fact increase trial incidence relative to private financing and can induce the plaintiff to sell a larger share. An optimal regulatory cap maximizing the litigants' joint welfare is always binding below the efficient risk benchmark.

Hedge Fund Trading around Shareholder Votes on Mergers: A Common Ownership Perspective – *with Luisa Ritzkat*
Recent theories on shareholder democracy predict that shareholders reallocate based on their preferences for the expected outcome of the vote. We extend these theories by incorporating common ownership. We predict that when shareholders benefit from a merger through their positions in industry competitors, they increase their ownership of the acquirer, and vice versa. To test our predictions, we study hedge fund trading in acquirers for mergers requiring shareholder approval. Hedge funds indeed increase their acquirer ownership by 0.6 pp per $100M in combined abnormal returns to horizontal competitors. With shareholder reallocation driven by cross-holdings, shareholder approval becomes disconnected from the acquirer's gains from the merger. Moreover, approval voting and announcement returns become systematically less informative to competition authorities.

Loss-Portfolio-Transfers in Reinsurance Markets
Work in progress

INTERESTS

Financial Economics, Industrial Organization
Microeconomic Theory, Applied Econometrics, Financial Intermediation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

European Central Bank *Starting 11/2026*
PhD Trainee – Market-based Finance Division

Collaborative Research Center 224 *07/2024 – Present*
Project Member, B03: Consumer Protection and Competition Policy

NERA Economic Consulting *06/2022 – 09/2022*
Analyst Intern – Antitrust and Competition Economics, Berlin, Germany

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Economic Policy – 2023, 2025, 2026 (Undergraduate)
Principles of Economics – 2024 (Undergraduate)
Statistics I – 2019 (Undergraduate)
Analysis and Linear Algebra A – 2018 (Undergraduate)

CONFERENCES

2026
MaCCI IO Day Mannheim, BCFM PhD Conference Cologne, EEA Congress Dublin, EALE Conference Warsaw, CRC-224 Retreat Bonn–Mannheim

2025
ENTER Jamboree Stockholm, CRC 224 Young Researchers Workshop Offenbach

AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

Center for Doctoral Studies in Economics Scholarship, 2021–2023
Studienstiftung des deutschen Volkes (Top 0.5% of students), 2021
Deutschlandstipendium (Top 1.5% of students), 2020
Erasmus+ Mobility Grant, University of Warwick, 2019

REFERENCES

Volker Nocke
University of Mannheim
Department of Economics
volker.nocke@gmail.com

Ernst Maug
University of Mannheim
Department of Finance
ernst.maug@uni-mannheim.de

Ernst-Ludwig von Thadden
University of Mannheim
Department of Economics
vthadden@uni-mannheim.de

MISCELLANEOUS

Programming & Tools
Languages: Python (pandas, numpy, OpenAI, statsmodels), Stata, R, Mathematica, LaTeX

Languages
German (Native), English (C2), Spanish (B2), Latin (Latinum)

Community Involvement
Actor - ATG Mannheim e.V. (Co-Founder) in 2017-2019 and University Theater in 2023-2024